

12 Month Plan

Farron Blanc |
March 2026

helm

Working Session

Team

First 5 Hires

- Co-founder CPO (month 1)
- Full stack Staff Engineer (month 2)
 - Builder not manager, BaaS API KYC experience
 - Deary Hudson (or network)
- Compliance Manager (month 2)
 - Disclosures, Design partners reviews
 - Stacy Koran (First Consulting)
- Contract Front-end & DevOps (month 3-4)
 - Make Sept launch
 - Front-end (reg flow), DevSecOps

Open Thoughts

Will need to rely on Runyon + EJF + Optimist to open aperture, leverage network

I run down every referral. Source via; wellfound, underdog, referrals

VPEng/CTO defer until pre-Series A unless S-Tier comes along

Gerry the mission resonated well with candidates, Helm will be more nuanced



Example Team

**Deary D. Hudson III**
Senior Software Engineer @ Backpack

Experience

**Senior Software Engineer**
Backpack · Full-time
Mar 2024 - Present · 2 yrs 1 mo
Remote
Creating digital infrastructure for 529 Payments.

**Software Engineer**
Wrapbook · Full-time
Apr 2021 - Apr 2023 · 2 yrs 1 mo
♥ Ruby on Rails and Ruby

**Technical Lead (Acquired)**
Gerry · Full-time
Apr 2020 - Jun 2021 · 1 yr 3 mos

**Software Engineer**
InfluxData · Full-time
Sep 2019 - Dec 2019 · 4 mos
- influxdb pkger <https://github.com/influxdata/influxdb/tree/master/pkgger>

**Data Engineer**
Knotch · Full-time
Apr 2015 - Sep 2019 · 4 yrs 6 mos
New York City Metropolitan Area
- Collecting events on the edge
- Employee # 6

Fractional to start

**Stacy Karon**
Vice President, First Consulting & Administration

Experience

**Vice President**
First Consulting & Administration
Oct 2023 - Present · 2 yrs 6 mos

**Associate General Counsel, Insurance Regulatory & Head of Compliance**
Ethos
Nov 2021 - Oct 2023 · 2 yrs

**Milliman**
8 yrs 1 mo

- Principal & Compliance Consultant**
Sep 2018 - Nov 2021 · 3 yrs 3 mos
Tampa/St. Petersburg, Florida Area
- Consultant**
Nov 2013 - Sep 2018 · 4 yrs 11 mos
Greater Tampa Bay Area

**Consultant**
First Consulting & Administration, Inc.
Mar 2001 - Nov 2013 · 12 yrs 9 mos

**Kevin Metzger**
Operational Risk and Compliance Manager at USAA

Show all →

Experience

**Risk and Compliance Manager**
USAA · Full-time
Jan 2018 - Present · 8 yrs 3 mos
San Antonio, Texas, United States
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills

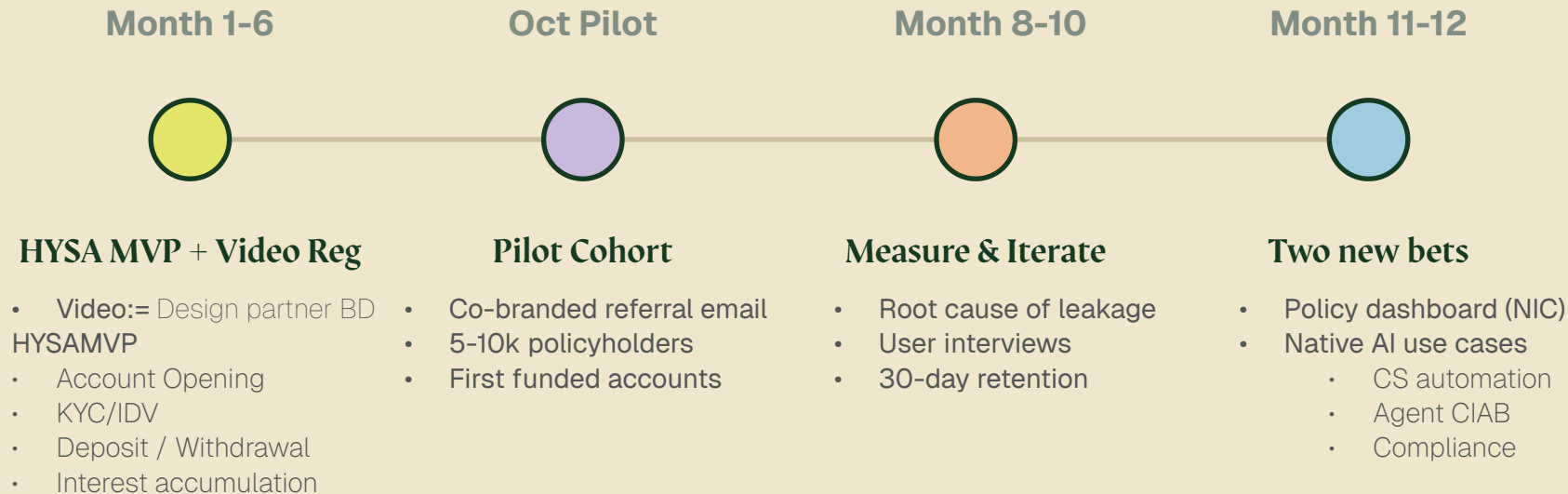
**Data Protection Manager**
The Lubrizol Corporation · Full-time
Apr 2015 - Jan 2018 · 2 yrs 10 mos
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills

**KeyBank**
Full-time · 1 yr 4 mos

- Vice President Compliance**
Mar 2014 - Jan 2015 · 11 mos
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills
- AVP Compliance**
Oct 2013 - Mar 2014 · 6 mos
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills



Product

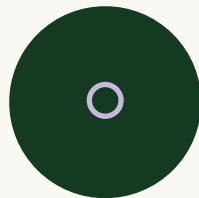


Go To Market



Banner Life

Second OKR = getting signed -
BUT default assumption is that
they stall out/flake out



NM or others

Advance NML
Fast follow (parallel) SBLI / MoO



IMO Distribution

Long term defensibility + drive
carriers

Warrants = evangelists
Crump (\$400M), LIBRA (\$500M),
Accuquote (\$80M)



Risks

Risk	Detail	Mitigation
Co-Founder & CPO Hire	- Helm needs to be world class in consumer fintech & B2B2C onboarding. - Need THE best otherwise I'm wrong person for seat.	Fly to SF spend 2 days "Overpay" to secure
Banner stalls and/or walks away	My base case assumption due to; - Cobalt distraction - Champion whose capital is finite - Compliance & ARB sign-off takes months	HYSA doesn't depend on Banner. Build regardless. Pivot to a new set of policyholders. Don't need carrier's permission if go through original distributor
Seed co-lead	Target June Closing with additional \$1.5M	List of 65 VCs
BaaS partner delays	Assuming 6 month MVP vs 12 month build	Parallel path BaaS (Unit, Treasury Prime, Cross River)
Compounding assumptions	Strong Series A (\$10-20M) is predicated on user conversion, growth, deposits, retention	Need pilot conversion stats Access to massive user base (NIC Acquisition)
Talent	Quickly building world class team in FinTech & Insurtech	Vision + Proof points + 'WIFM'





helm

Navigate uncertain futures with certainty

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